■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, October 09, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■ *Using AI for just 10 minutes erodes your ability to persist at hard things*

The Angle: *Using AI for just 10 minutes erodes your ability to persist at hard things*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.berkeley.edu/2026/10/09/using-ai-for-just-10-minutes-erodes-your-ability-to-persist-at-hard-things/

■■ *Steve Buscemi: "What's happening in Gaza is awful and they need our help. They need the world's help."*

The Angle: *A beloved character actor best known for quirky roles is using his platform to push a serious humanitarian message - and it's the latest example of Hollywood stars wading into one of the most divisive topics going right now.*

- **Steve Buscemi** publicly said: **"What's happening in Gaza is awful and they need our help. They need the world's help."**
- The comment is circulating out of **r/fauxmoi**, a celebrity-gossip community, showing how far celebrity political statements travel online

The Debate Starter

- Do you want your favorite actors speaking out on world crises, or should celebrities just stick to the movies?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/ursx97ajeiuh1

■ *After winning the Nobel Peace Prize, Navi Pillay says, "If you clap a little bit more I may share this prize with Trump"*

The Angle: *Trump's years-long public campaign to win a Nobel Peace Prize is practically a running joke at this point, so when the actual winner takes a direct shot at him, it's an instant watercooler moment.*

- **Navi Pillay** won this year's **Nobel Peace Prize**.
- Her response to the attention: **"If you clap a little bit more I may share this prize with Trump."**
- The quote is circulating on **r/fauxmoi** as a jab at **Trump's** well-known desire to win the award himself.

The Shade Starter

- Savage comeback or a little too petty for a Nobel laureate - where do you land?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/m977ffrezfuh1

■ *Alberta woman, 61, breaks her own world record by planking for 5 hours*

The Angle: *A 61-year-old grandmother of 12 broke her own Guinness World Record by holding a plank for five hours — the kind of jaw-dropping, feel-good feat that makes for an instant watercooler moment and a gut-check for anyone who's tapped out at 60 seconds.*

- **DonnaJean Wilde**, 61, is a grandmother of **12**
- She broke her own **Guinness World Record** for the longest female abdominal plank

- The feat happened at the **Huntsman World Senior Games** in Utah this week

The Humble-Brag Check

- Be honest — how long could you actually hold a plank right now?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Live Plank Challenge** - 60 seconds, right now in studio -> Both hosts drop and hold a plank on air while the other talks, timing who taps out first
- **Step 2: Caller Brag-Off** - 2-3 minutes, phone lines open -> Ask listeners to call in with their best plank time or craziest personal-record attempt at any age

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/planking-world-record-canadian-9.7376072?cmp=rss

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■ *'Crypto King' investor recounts the moment he learned $311M investment fund didn't exist*

The Angle: *A self-styled teen crypto mogul allegedly burned investors out of $311 million that never actually existed - and now one of his own friends is testifying about the moment the whole thing unraveled in his own living room.*

- **Aiden Pleterski**, dubbed the "**Crypto King**," is accused of running an investment fund worth **$311 million** - that prosecutors say simply didn't exist.
- A friend and investor showed up at Pleterski's **lakefront mansion** in **June 2022** demanding "proof in person" of his account balance.
- Pleterski has pleaded **not guilty** to **fraud over $5,000** and **money laundering**.
- The story is playing out in court via **CBC** as the trial digs into how the alleged scheme stayed hidden for so long.

The Trust Test

- Would you ever drive to a friend's house and demand to see your money with your own eyes - and what would you do if he couldn't show you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/crypto-king-ponzi-scheme-mitchell-learning-9.7376238?cmp=rss

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■ *Vance, Republican lawmakers and religious leaders oppose Pentagon plan to livestream an execution*

The Angle: *This isn't some fringe idea — it's a sitting administration weighing whether to broadcast a firing squad execution, and it's got Republicans, religious leaders, and Trump's own VP pushing back. That's a rare moment of bipartisan-flavored outrage worth unpacking.*

- **JD Vance**, Republican lawmakers, and religious leaders all came out against the plan on Friday
- The Pentagon's proposal would **livestream an execution by firing squad**
- **President Trump** says he has **not yet decided** whether to actually allow the live feed
- International observers have also voiced opposition to the plan

The Debate Starter

- Is there ANY justification for broadcasting an execution live, or is this a hard no no matter who's being executed?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/vance-reaction-pentagon-execution-livestream-hegseth-9.7376261?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Nightmare American Airlines flight forced to divert to JFK Airport after 6 restrooms fail midair*

The Angle: *A plane full of passengers, a multi-hour flight, and only two working toilets for the whole cabin — this is the kind of travel-nightmare story that makes everyone wince and share their own worst flight story.*

- **6 of the plane's 8 lavatories** stopped working mid-flight

- That left passengers sharing just **2 working restrooms** for the entire cabin
- The flight was forced to divert and land at **JFK Airport**

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's the worst in-flight mishap you've ever been stuck with — call in and top this one.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/10/us-news/nightmare-american-airlines-flight-forced-to-divert-to-jfk-after-6-restrooms-fail-midair/

■ *Hurricane Isaias hit Florida ‘like a freight train’ as storm leaves over 420K without power, Lt. Gov. Jay Collins says*

The Angle: *A hurricane just hit the Panhandle 'like a freight train' and knocked out power for nearly half a million people — this is the kind of real, breaking weather story that affects travel, family check-ins, and safety for folks across the region right now.*

- Lt. Gov. **Jay Collins** says Hurricane **Isaias** hit Florida's Panhandle 'like a freight train'
- More than **430,000 customers** lost power Friday night into Saturday morning
- Storm made landfall overnight, catching the outage spike right at peak sleeping hours

The Check-In Prompt

- Anyone got family or friends riding this one out without power right now?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/10/us-news/hurricane-isaias-hit-florida-like-a-freight-train-as-storm-leaves-thousands-without-power-lt-gov-jay-collins-says/

■ *CBSA intercepts firearm suppressors from the U.S. A Toronto cop has been charged*

The Angle: *CBSA intercepts firearm suppressors from the U.S. A Toronto cop has been charged*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMivwFBVV95cUxQX1dZM2JJbTRBVHdPcENTblJjdFhSUkVBN2pPV0FMbjhDWmVyOGVBel9maW5Db1FXQ0dOUXdoMHhYblEyeGhlc1BSTFhOenpiUzdNclBuVDdlZThwZDlNdk9WcXlwUFF4OF8tSFJQcTVNNnFxRGU4VThsOGxSa18wMlJZcWZpTjNuLTlZNGF6aUV4NjZPamxIbEVheDNHV3FibHpzQXpuNV9vcFR3SWRkN0M3OTR4RE82SWJZYlVyWQ?oc=5

■ *Trump says tariffs have brought more U.S. auto factories. His numbers are off.*

The Angle: *Trump says tariffs have brought more U.S. auto factories. His numbers are off.*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMixgFBVV95cUxNZjNNaFFXVVRWVHc0Z1cwRkZyeFdlVXB1NENPY1g1RWpVR1ZoUzVjSG5aVHMtbXJSNU9xeE55SmRLNVRIRWREWVZFUXhIRVRqOExhWEYzZ1JtMWt0Tm9MaEZGQkFpaTZScEdodkxfMHNpOGt4bGZNNjFBSTZ4WUxkdDhfRXNVVnFKUFd0MEV2bjN5SGdWZkNyS0NCTk4yV0NqTklaQURCQzc3cHlNSFR1UHNhX0tZblJmcEd5bE1JVVZhaUc3THc?oc=5

■ *Trump selects Katie Zacharia as next White House press secretary*

The Angle: *Trump selects Katie Zacharia as next White House press secretary*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMipAFBVV95cUxOcnFzMFcwQWdVeVhXLThFaGE4Nmg3d0dCLUl3SDhQTWE2djA1blVlMjBwbFhON0VUNU5oUjE3T0ZZeVhzcXk4aW9UWW9UZXdGWUZDbldRODJKSHZLcGRIa0dFQm1SZWlxRVYyM3hFbVBRY2J1WVpMdkwyY1N6Y1JRdm13T3ZGR3JybEtxMjVTT25HZEJBRmRvOHQtRUN0WGd2MlNwWQ?oc=5

■ *FCC Chair Brendan Carr Says Pete Hegseth Has Final Say On Broadcasting Fort Hood Shooter’s Execution*

The Angle: *FCC Chair Brendan Carr Says Pete Hegseth Has Final Say On Broadcasting Fort Hood Shooter's Execution*

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://gizmodo.com/fcc-chair-brendan-carr-says-pete-hegseth-has-final-say-on-broadcasting-fort-hood-shooters-execution-2000824507

CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■■ *European states, Canada, Japan and UN back ICC against US sanctions*

The Angle: *Canada's joining a wall of allies - European countries, Japan, and the UN - standing behind the International Criminal Court after Washington slapped it with sanctions, and that kind of open split with the US on the world stage is rare enough to talk about.*

- **Canada** is among the countries publicly backing the **ICC** against **US sanctions**.
- **European states**, **Japan**, and the **United Nations** have also come out in support of the court.
- The dispute centers on **US sanctions** targeting the International Criminal Court itself.

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be picking fights with its biggest ally over an international court, or is this exactly when allies are supposed to push back?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.aljazeera.com/amp/news/2026/10/9/european-states-canada-japan-and-un-back-icc-against-us-sanctions

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■ *Canada sheds 68,000 jobs, unemployment rate up to 6.5% in September*

The Angle: *Unemployment jumping to 6.5% is the kind of number that hits everyone's wallet and dinner-table conversation - it's a real signal the economy's cooling, not just a stat on a government spreadsheet.*

- Canada shed **68,000 jobs** in September
- National unemployment rate climbed to **6.5%**

The Gut-Check Question

- Are you or anyone you know feeling the pinch right now - hiring freezes, layoffs, fewer hours?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ipolitics.ca/2026/10/09/canada-sheds-68000-jobs-unemployment-rate-up-to-6-5-in-september/

■ *Residential school denialism shouldn't be illegal, Manitoba Premier Wab Kinew says | CBC News*

The Angle: *Manitoba's Premier — the first First Nations premier in the province's history — is pushing back on criminalizing residential school denialism, a stance that cuts against where a lot of Indigenous advocates want this conversation to go.*

- **Wab Kinew**, Manitoba's Premier, says residential school denialism **shouldn't be made illegal**.
- **Kinew** is Manitoba's first First Nations premier, which adds weight to his position on this.
- The comments come amid ongoing national debate over how Canada should legally handle Indigenous history denial.

The Debate Starter

- Should denying residential school history be free speech, or should there be a legal line — and who gets to draw it?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/residential-school-denialism-bill-manitoba-9.7375501

■ *'Not as long as I'm premier': Danielle Smith rules out 2nd separation referendum if Albertans vote to remain*

The Angle: *'Not as long as I'm premier': Danielle Smith rules out 2nd separation referendum if Albertans vote to remain*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/alberta-premier-danielle-smith-referendum-vote-9.7376571?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Anti-ICE protests continue in NYC after agents shoot man in car with child*

The Angle: *A child in the backseat when federal agents opened fire is the kind of detail that stops a scroll — and it's why protests outside ICE facilities in New York haven't let up. For a Canadian audience watching U.S. immigration enforcement get more aggressive under this administration, it's a flashpoint worth talking about.*

- **ICE agents** opened fire on a man **with a child in the vehicle** in **New York City**
- Protests against the agency have **continued for multiple days** since the shooting
- The incident has reignited scrutiny over **ICE use-of-force tactics** during enforcement stops

The Debate Starter

- Does having a kid in the car change how you judge this — or should agents never be opening fire during a traffic stop, period?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/livestory/nyc-ice-shooting-dhs-mamdani-mullin-new-york-dominican-9.7375447?cmp=rss

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■ *Hurricane Isaias makes landfall on U.S. Gulf Coast as Category 2 storm*

The Angle: *A major hurricane just made landfall in the U.S. with storm surge and flooding threats - worth a quick check-in since storm systems like this can ripple north and affect travel and weather across the border.*

- **Hurricane Isaias** hit the **U.S. Gulf Coast** as a **Category 2** storm on Friday
- It slammed into **Alabama** and the **Florida Panhandle**
- Hosts dealt with **damaging winds**, **heavy rain**, and **flooding**
- Officials warned of **life-threatening storm surge** in the area

The Quick Hit

- Anyone got family or friends riding this one out down south?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/hurricane-isaias-us-gulf-coast-landfall-9.7376981?cmp=rss

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■ *'I feel like I'm being punished for doing well': Calgary cancer patient seeks continued drug funding*

The Angle: *A Calgary cancer patient says the province is cutting off funding for her medication because her health improved - a gut-punch irony that cuts right to the heart of how broken drug coverage rules can be.*

- A **Calgary** cancer patient is fighting to keep funding for her medication.
- Her quote: **"I feel like I'm being punished for doing well."**
- The case raises questions about how drug coverage programs define 'success' for patients.

The Debate Starter

- Should getting healthier ever cost a patient their medication funding?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi0gFBVV95cUxOa21wX2UyQVVqMWxQbnlZREU5ZFhoUDVzcG13WWg4d1ktVTRhWG5jU3ZEelB2VGozYjZUbXpNTDB2MThiZFRsX29kTHZVSWYzZVNVSHhPYWhXbk1Sanh4czRONXZZa3lFMnhXTDVrYmVZQ2dTb3Q3N3NRSEVvalRsb1RveDdQUjNrTURlZTgycUlHSEtadDlERzE5NGhLUjFabGsxSDdtRXk1VnV1enJOb19EaEtvdnd0Z3d5aHl3eC0zUUpNZjRTaVZHRDFIVGxqdHc?oc=5

■■ *A debt collector threatened ‘reputational destruction.’ Now it owes $34,000*

The Angle: *A debt collector got slapped with a $34,000 penalty after allegedly threatening someone with "reputational destruction" over a debt — a wild turn-the-tables story about aggressive collection tactics finally backfiring.*

- A debt collector allegedly threatened **"reputational destruction"** against a person over a debt
- That collector has now been ordered to pay **$34,000**
- Story comes via **CTV News**

The Debate Starter

- Have you ever had a debt collector cross the line with threats — and did you fight back?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMisgFBVV95cUxQVGRKSjJuUGFBZm5lWmVkQThDbUdwZXFrQWo0TDVZUVE4QURsc2gwckZNVDN6Z3FLX0xNT2M0WEU2ZlFSV1RobnkyaHFQQTJueUpWazJsRFhUV1BhNjNhMXFyOUh0YzFSVXR1NFlILUxjXzE1UTNTeFZvSU5mLUp1U3NYZ3dTUVRKT2ViR0hwT1E0NmVYeDJsS3JGX0NkSjI4NTJDTWxUS2h2MUJWN1doZEln?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *Ella Langley's bikini selfie has fans calling her 'the most perfect woman' on Instagram - Fox News*

The Angle: *Country star Ella Langley dropped a bikini selfie in her tour photo dump and the caption alone has fans spiraling in the comments — easy, breezy celebrity content with built-in reactions to riff on.*

- **Ella Langley**, 27, shared a bikini selfie as part of a photo dump from her **Dandelion tour**
- Her caption played on "not enough in the world," which fans latched onto and ran with in the comments
- Commenters called her **"the most perfect woman"** on Instagram

The Reaction Read

- Read a few of the wildest fan comments on air and let the hosts rate them for thirst-level.

Fox News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.foxnews.com/entertainment/ella-langley-bikini-selfie-fans-calling-most-perfect-woman-instagram

■ *Guillermo del Toro on Digger’s box office numbers: “Love the arts Fuck the charts”*

The Angle: *Guillermo del Toro on Digger’s box office numbers: “Love the arts Fuck the charts”*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/gm3f7s165huh1.jpeg

■ *A Newfoundlander got a random call from a bunch of Hollywood stars — and just went with it*

The Angle: *A total stranger picks up his phone expecting a telemarketer and ends up chatting with a Hollywood star and a Netflix cast - it's the ultimate "you won't believe who called me" story, and it's got that wholesome East Coast charm people love.*

- **Paul Matthews**, from Newfoundland, picked up a call last month with zero idea who was on the line.
- The call came from **Jax Irwin**, who apparently just cold-calls people on the east coast to chat.
- This time she had Hollywood actor **Josh Hartnett** and the cast of a new **Netflix** show along for the ride.
- Matthews just rolled with the whole thing instead of hanging up.

The Phone-In Trigger

- If a random number called you right now with a movie star on the line, would you actually stay on - or hang up thinking it's a scam?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/thecurrent/newfoundland-cold-call-jax-irwin-netflix-below-9.7375980?cmp=rss

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■ *Crazy Rich Asians to get the TV treatment with original stars on HBO*

The Angle: *The 2018 rom-com that broke box office records is getting an eight-episode HBO series, and the original stars are all coming back - that's the kind of sequel news that actually gets fans excited instead of groaning.*

- **HBO** is turning **Crazy Rich Asians** into an **eight-episode series**
- **Constance Wu** is set to return
- **Henry Golding** is set to return
- **Michelle Yeoh** is set to return

The Debate Starter

- Movie-to-TV expansions are everywhere right now - are you here for it, or should some stories just stay a two-hour movie?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/crazy-rich-asians-hbo-series-cast-returns-9.7375805?cmp=rss

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■ *'Helluva Boss' actor Brandon Rogers lashes out at heckler at NY Comic Con: 'You need to shut the f–k up'*

The Angle: *A beloved animated villain's voice just went full real-life villain on a fan — convention blowups always travel fast online, and this one's got a quotable meltdown attached.*

- **Brandon Rogers**, voice of **Blitzo** on *Helluva Boss*, got into it with a heckler during a panel at **NY Comic Con**.
- He told the attendee: **"You need to get the f--- out right now or I will make you leave."**
- Headline quote has him adding: **"You need to shut the f--k up."**

The Debate Starter

- Was he justified in snapping, or did the voice actor lose the room by going nuclear on a fan?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/10/celebrity-news/helluva-boss-actor-brandon-rogers-lashes-out-at-heckler-at-new-york-comic-con-during-panel/

Backup options:

■ *Liberty's season ends with a disappointing dud — but the questions are just beginning*

The Angle: *Liberty's season ends with a disappointing dud — but the questions are just beginning*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/09/sports/libertys-season-ends-in-a-disappointing-dud-as-questions-loom/

■ *'Animals' Review: Ben Affleck Returns to the Director's Chair for a Nasty, Compulsive Kidnapping Thriller - Variety*

The Angle: *'Animals' Review: Ben Affleck Returns to the Director's Chair for a Nasty, Compulsive Kidnapping Thriller - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/reviews/animals-review-ben-affleck-1236906114/

■ *Marvel's 'VisionQuest' Surprise Premiere NYCC, First Reactions - Variety*

The Angle: *Marvel ambushed fans with a full episode screening instead of just a trailer, and the first reactions are already flooding social media days before the real premiere.*

- Marvel closed out its **New York Comic Con** panel **Thursday** with a surprise screening of the first episode of **"VisionQuest"**
- The **Disney+** series is officially set to premiere **Oct. 14**
- Early reactions from the NYCC crowd are already circulating online ahead of the wide release

The Fan Reaction Check

- Marvel let a room full of superfans see it first - are surprise premieres the new marketing move studios should lean into?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/marvel-visionquest-surprise-premieres-nycc-first-reactions-1236906093/

■ *The First Trailer for ‘Exorcist: Martyrs’ Could Make You Forget All Your ‘Carrie’ Complaints*

The Angle: *Flanagan just wrapped his Stephen King series on Prime Video and he's already got a new horror movie teaser out, and critics are saying it might finally live up to the franchise's name after that rough 'Believer' reboot.*

- **Mike Flanagan** — the director behind Netflix's **'The Haunting'** series — just dropped the first trailer for **'Exorcist: Martyrs'**
- The teaser landed right as his Stephen King adaptation premiered on **Prime Video**
- Early buzz compares it favorably to the recent **'Carrie'** remake, which fans largely trashed

The Debate Starter

- Is Flanagan horror's most reliable name right now, or has every franchise reboot just been riding nostalgia?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/exorcist-martyrs-trailer-mike-flanagan-nycc-2026-2000824430

■ *Lance Bass reveals shockingly low amount he claims he earned while in *NSYNC: ‘Working for free’*

The Angle: *A founding member of one of the biggest boy bands ever just said the fame didn't pay the bills - it's the kind of old-school music industry horror story that always gets listeners fired up about shady contracts.*

- **Lance Bass** says he earned a shockingly small amount during his time in **NSYNC**
- He describes it bluntly as **"working for free"**
- **NSYNC** formed back in **1995** and went on to become one of the best-selling boy bands in history

The Debate Starter

- If you found out your biggest career moment barely paid you anything, would you still call it worth it?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/09/celebrity-news/lance-bass-reveals-shockingly-low-amount-he-claims-he-earned-while-in-nsync/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Ice cream stand owner goes viral after defending young workers from rude customers*

The Angle: *A small business owner's online rant sticking up for his young employees against rude customers struck a nerve online - it's the kind of 'customer service is broken' story that gets everyone sharing their own worst-customer tale.*

- Shop owner **Dave Miller** posted an online rant defending his **young employees** from rude customers
- The rant went out last **Sunday** and quickly spread online
- It's resonating as a broader statement on how customers treat **teen and young workers** in service jobs

The Debate Starter

- Phone lines open: what's the worst you've seen a customer treat a teenage worker, and did anyone ever stand up for them like this?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/ice-cream-stand-owner-viral-defend-young-workers-rude-customers

Backup options:

■ *Guardians erupt in sixth inning to stun White Sox in Game 4 of ALDS, force deciding Game 5 - CBS Sports*

The Angle: *Down 2-0 in the series and trailing again on the road, Cleveland clawed back twice to beat Chicago and push this ALDS to a win-or-go-home Game 5 - the kind of comeback that makes for must-watch October baseball.*

- **Guardians** beat the **White Sox 9-5** in Game 4 of the ALDS
- Cleveland trailed **2-0** in the best-of-five series before winning both games in Chicago
- The **Guardians** came back from behind **multiple times** on the road Thursday night
- Series now heads to a deciding **Game 5**

The Debate Starter

- Does a team that just erased a 2-0 series deficit now have more momentum than anybody in October?

CBS Sports (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbssports.com/mlb/news/guardians-white-sox-alds-game-4-mlb-playoffs/

■ *Finally, a Show Made Up of Tech-Company Episodes of The Good Wife - Vulture*

The Angle: *The team behind The Good Wife is returning with 'Cupertino,' a new show stacked with theater heavyweights that takes direct aim at the tech industry - basically every juicy tech-bro storyline The Good Wife ever teased, now the whole show.*

- New series is called **'Cupertino'** - a not-so-subtle nod to Apple's hometown
- Created by **Robert and Michelle King**, the duo behind **The Good Wife**
- Cast pulls from a **deep bench of New York theater legends**
- Vulture frames it as skewering **'America's current heart of darkness'** - aka the tech industry

The Debate Starter

- Is Big Tech the new go-to Hollywood villain, replacing Wall Street and Big Pharma?

Vulture (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.vulture.com/article/cupertino-is-just-like-the-chumhum-episodes-of-good-wife.html

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *A study of over 80,000 learners found that even 1–2 second loading delays can disrupt online education*

The Angle: *We've all blamed bad wifi for zoning out of a video call, but new research says the buffering itself might be breaking your brain's focus - a relatable gripe for anyone doing online learning, remote work training, or even streaming.*

- The study tracked over **80,000 learners** in an online education setting.
- Delays of just **1 to 2 seconds** in page or video loading were enough to disrupt learning.
- Researchers tie the slowdown directly to broken focus and engagement, not just annoyance.

The Relatable Rant

- Call in: what's the smallest tech glitch that completely derails your focus - a buffering wheel, a slow Wi-Fi bar, a frozen screen?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nature.com/articles/s41562-026-02598-y

Backup options:

■ *Research shows doctors' prescribing habits are heavily influenced by payments, gifts, and free meals from pharmaceutical companies, leading to more expensive, less appropriate and more drugs being prescribed.*

The Angle: *New research digs into how pharma freebies - meals, gifts, speaking fees - quietly steer what doctors prescribe, often toward pricier and less necessary drugs. It's the kind of 'wait, that's legal?' story that makes everyone side-eye their own doctor's lunch habits.*

- Research (via **r/science**) links pharma **payments, gifts, and free meals** to changes in doctor prescribing behavior
- The influence trends toward **more expensive** drug choices
- It also correlates with **less medically appropriate** prescriptions being written
- Overall effect: doctors end up prescribing **more drugs overall**, not just different ones

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust your doctor less if you found out a drug rep bought their lunch this week?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1146170

■ *Research shows that the invisible mental load of planning and organizing household life predicts women's relationship and sexual satisfaction more strongly than the division of physical chores like cooking or cleaning.*

The Angle: *New research says the mental load - remembering the dentist appointment, planning dinner, tracking the school forms - predicts a woman's relationship and sexual satisfaction more than who actually does the chores. It reframes the whole "fair division of labor" fight couples have.*

- Study found the **invisible mental load** of planning and organizing household life matters more than physical chores like **cooking or cleaning**
- Researchers linked that mental load specifically to **women's relationship satisfaction**
- It also predicted **sexual satisfaction** - not just "who's annoyed about laundry"

The Debate Starter

- Phone lines: couples, who's actually carrying the mental load in your house - and does your partner even know it exists?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/the-invisible-chore-that-may-matter-more-for-womens-relationship-happiness-than-housework/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *'I probably didn't get enough attention in childhood': Comedian opens new B.C. comedy and arts space*

The Angle: *'I probably didn't get enough attention in childhood': Comedian opens new B.C. comedy and arts space*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi6AFBVV95cUxNUE1oTmxkOWhycUR5TktJV3YtQklfTjd2T2ZoYXRUdGtKTG9ZMUE4UVdFaVgzY2p5cTd5X2lvQUJmNUN2cnpya2dqMGZST2dBZUxGN2ttaEZmMGNQV2MwcksycEd0b3dOM2F0UjFGZFRCeng5N3pOTEJiR2Y0MzAxSDZ3UkVaRDVlQ0FMSzNsR1d5UTRLbnVlSkg4b2lzVjdOVWFqUTNJcVdISnFwdVNCSFpzZzg2cmdCekxGajl6MW0xUkRIQ29qYzd

QNDd3ZW1zNXJFeGtVMUxWWGNkbmFidkJMdkJLZEdv?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *Barbara Palvin Marks Her First Birthday as a Mom with Photos of Herself Cradling Daughter Sylvie - People.com*

The Angle: *Barbara Palvin Marks Her First Birthday as a Mom with Photos of Herself Cradling Daughter Sylvie - People.com*

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiwgFBVV95cUxPZlBKeVVHMnVTUGg0WWVkc3A3d0Vfa2JHLU9abVRSQUhBQ3plR1JPZU5TRklKN1l5TF8zZVNPZWZlN0V1bUV4SUdoRmpvaGpLX0lISHJhWVMtSjUyS1NVSVpUa2lHdkduVXo2TUx0a19iMDBCb1BEeHFNVHNpMi1RTDc1Xy16T2V2Qlp6emZZSmkyem1Vekxia0VZQjhtMmk2cUZ2bVhNeHozR0Fpc0s5bmduaG1IZnJvWDYxaW9CakxpUQ?oc=5

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *After Almost Going Extinct, Giant Tortoises Now Outnumber People in The Seychelles. Ample food supply and little predation enabled them to reach famously ripe old ages, and all without much need for speed or aggression.*

The Angle: *Giant tortoises nearly vanished from the Seychelles, and now they outnumber the actual humans living there — a wild comeback story with a built-in "why can't I live that chill" angle for listeners.*

- **Giant tortoises** in the **Seychelles** now outnumber the human population there.
- These tortoises nearly went **extinct** before this turnaround.
- **Ample food** and almost no **predators** let them reach famously **old ages**.
- They never had to evolve **speed or aggression** — nothing's chasing them.

The Debate Starter

- What's the human version of the tortoise life — zero stress, zero hustle, just eat and outlive everybody?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/after-almost-going-extinct-giant-tortoises-now-outnumber-people-in-the-seychelles

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■ *Moms who vacuumed, aired out futons and used anti-mite covers more often while pregnant had toddlers less likely to show signs of developmental delays at 18 months to 3 years, in a Japanese study of over 81,000 mother-child pairs. The more often they cleaned, the lower the odds.*

The Angle: *Moms who vacuumed, aired out futons and used anti-mite covers more often while pregnant had toddlers less likely to show signs of developmental delays at 18 months to 3 years, in a Japanese study of over 81,000 mother-child pairs. The more often they cleaned, the lower the odds.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://link.springer.com/article/10.1186/s12887-026-07588-7

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 13 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka’Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: ‘I can’t eat as much’" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of ‘The Life of a Showgirl,’ Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks " (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)
- "SteelSeries brings ultra-wideband wireless to gaming mice, chasing lag-free tracking" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-30)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)
- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/entertainment (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.huffpost.com (fetch failed)
- deadline.com (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

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